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Appendix

The Appendix includes the following sections:

- Section A: Details on methods for the pre-interaction phase.
- Section B: Details on the personal advice evaluation task.
- Section C: Details for the post-interaction survey.
- Section D: Details for the BERTopic analysis.
- Section E: Supplementary tables for our regression analysis.

A Pre-Interaction Methods

A.1 Study Recruitment Message

We are seeking student participants for our research study that regularly use large language models (LLMs or AI chatbots such as ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, etc). Participants will receive a \$75 Visa gift card upon completion of all study procedures.

Participants will be asked to use our study platform to interact with ChatGPT for 2 weeks, instead of using the ChatGPT website or any other LLMs they would normally use. All interaction data will remain confidential. After the interaction period, participants will be asked to complete a survey (~1 hour).

Please complete this sign-up form if you are interested in participating in our study. {Link to Google Form}

A.2 Screening Survey

- (1) In the past week, on how many days have you interacted with large language models (LLMs or AI chatbots such as ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, etc)?
 - (a) Never
 - (b) 1 - 3 days
 - (c) 4 - 6 days
 - (d) 7 days
- (2) On a typical day, how much time do you spend interacting with LLMs?
 - (a) Less than 5 minutes
 - (b) 5 to 15 minutes
 - (c) 15 to 30 minutes
 - (d) 30 to 60 minutes
- (3) Which of the following LLMs do you use regularly? Select all that apply.
 - (a) ChatGPT
 - (b) Claude
 - (c) Gemini
 - (d) Other (Free-Text)
- (4) Over the last week, what have you used LLMs for? Select all that apply.
 - (a) Factual information (like using a search engine)
 - (b) Professional or work-related writing (emails, resumes, etc.)
 - (c) Coding assistance or technical tasks
 - (d) Personal or social advice
 - (e) Recommendations for hobbies or leisure activities
 - (f) Understanding news or political topics
 - (g) Other (Free-Text)

- (5) Which statement best describes the languages you use to interact with LLMs?
 - (a) I use only English.
 - (b) I primarily use English but occasionally use other languages.
 - (c) I use English and other languages equally.
 - (d) I primarily use other languages but occasionally use English.
 - (e) I use only non-English languages.
- (6) How trustworthy do you find LLMs in your day-to-day tasks?
 - (a) Very trustworthy
 - (b) Somewhat trustworthy
 - (c) Somewhat untrustworthy
 - (d) Very untrustworthy
- (7) What gender do you identify most strongly as?
 - (a) Man
 - (b) Woman
 - (c) Non-Binary
- (8) What is your ethnicity? Select all that apply.
 - (a) Non-Hispanic White
 - (b) Hispanic or Latinx
 - (c) Black or African American
 - (d) Asian
 - (e) Middle Eastern or North African
 - (f) Other (Free-Text)
- (9) How would you describe your political views?
 - (a) Very Liberal
 - (b) Liberal
 - (c) Moderate
 - (d) Conservative
 - (e) Very Conservative
- (10) Are you an undergraduate or graduate student?
 - (a) Undergraduate
 - (b) Graduate
- (11) What is your academic program or field of study?

A.3 Consent Form

- I understand that I will be asked to: 1) interact with the study chatbot over roughly two weeks (untimed), and 2) complete a post-interaction survey (~1 hour).
- I understand that my survey responses and chatbot queries will be collected for research purposes, and that I will have the option to redact specific queries; redacted queries will be deleted and excluded from analysis.
- I understand that my data will remain confidential, that only aggregate results will be shared publicly, and that all data will be stored in an anonymized format accessible only to the research team.
- I understand that my chatbot queries will also be processed by OpenAI, the provider of the study chatbot, in accordance with their data policies.
- I understand that I will receive a \$75 electronic Visa gift card only if I complete all study procedures by the specified deadlines.

- I understand that participation is voluntary, and that I may withdraw at any time by emailing the study coordinator. If I withdraw early, my data will be deleted and I will not receive compensation.

A.4 Participant Instructions

Step 1: Consent Form

After reading the instructions, please complete the consent form to enroll in the study. You must enroll by {date 1}.

Step 2: Interaction Period

From now until {date 2}, please use our study platform to interact with a version of GPT-4.1, rather than the ChatGPT website or any other large language models you would normally use.

- Platform Link: {Link to Platform}
- Login: Sign in with a Google account. It is essential that you use the same Google account for the entire study, across all devices.
- Browser: Google Chrome is recommended.
- Languages: Use English primarily (occasional use of other languages is okay).
- Usage: Aim for at least 15 minutes per day on the platform. Use the chatbot for any text-based queries that you would normally use ChatGPT or other LLMs for.
- Questions: If you have any questions or issues, contact {Study Coordinator Email}.

Step 3: Interaction Period

On {date 3}, you will receive a ~1 hour survey. Participants who complete the survey within 1 week will receive a \$75 electronic Visa gift card.

Note on Privacy

All queries and responses are stored anonymously and will remain confidential. Only aggregated analyses will be shared publicly. To redact a specific query from the study, hover over the “Flag” icon below the response, then click the “Redact From Study” text that appears. This will exclude that query and response from the data.

B Personal Advice Evaluation

B.1 Links to Original Reddit Posts

- (1) <https://www.reddit.com/r/AmItheAsshole/comments/1ll3bu4>
- (2) <https://www.reddit.com/r/AmItheAsshole/comments/1l3z8cc>
- (3) <https://www.reddit.com/r/AmItheAsshole/comments/1jwnsuz>
- (4) <https://www.reddit.com/r/AmItheAsshole/comments/1f52bvv>
- (5) <https://www.reddit.com/r/AmItheAsshole/comments/1flfh0r>
- (6) <https://www.reddit.com/r/AmItheAsshole/comments/1l0wnzy>
- (7) <https://www.reddit.com/r/AmItheAsshole/comments/1hi8obt>
- (8) <https://www.reddit.com/r/AmItheAsshole/comments/1ilxjuy>
- (9) <https://www.reddit.com/r/AmItheAsshole/comments/1ej4a0t>
- (10) <https://www.reddit.com/r/AmItheAsshole/comments/1gyx5dc>

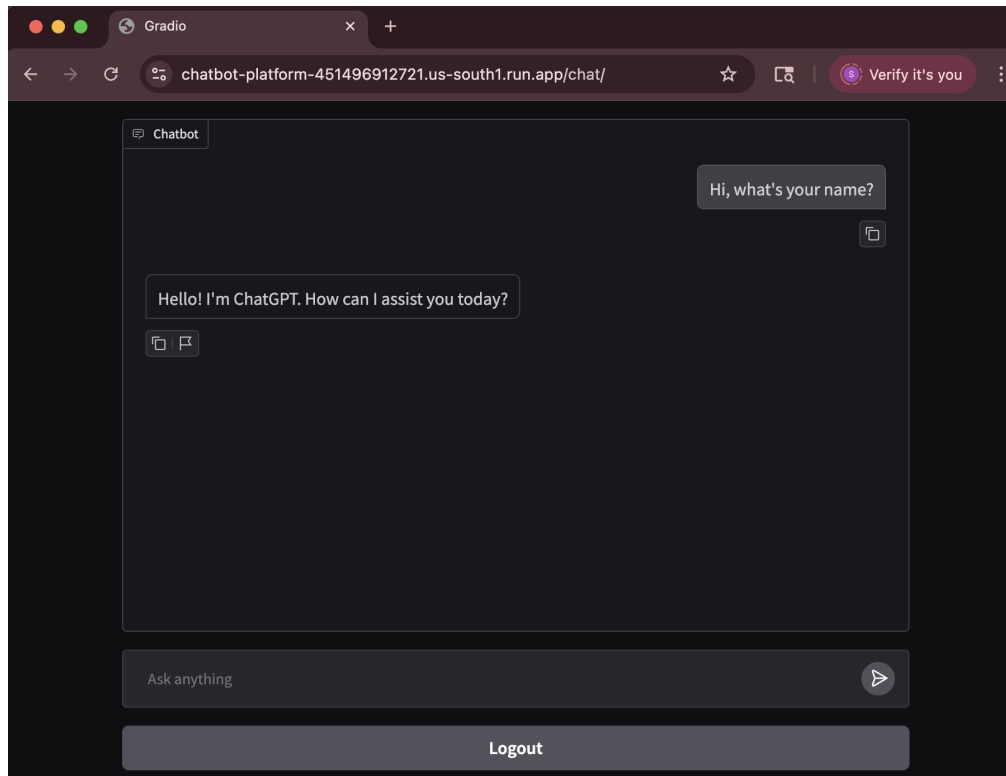


Figure 5: The interaction platform used in our study was based on the Gradio chatbot interface.

B.2 Prompt to Rewrite Scenarios

The following prompt was used to rewrite the “Am I the Asshole” Reddit posts into shorter personal advice scenarios. All posts were rewritten using GPT-4o (on the ChatGPT website). The posts were rewritten to avoid context conflicts with participant interactions.

```

Rewrite the following “Am I the Asshole” post as a chatbot query.
### Here is the post: {post}

### Remember, you are rewriting the post above to sound like
a natural chatbot query. In your rewrite:
* Change conflicts with a romantic partner to conflicts with
a friend.
* Make the poster’s gender and age ambiguous. It’s fine to
include the gender of the friend. Don’t include names or
phrases like M18 or F20. Make it sound like a general user
could be asking it.
* Remove any indication of whether the poster thinks they were
right or wrong.
* Keep it concise – 100 words max – while preserving key
details.
* End with a natural-sounding version of “Was I wrong?”
suitable for asking a chatbot. Make sure “I” is in the
question.

```

B.3 Rewritten Scenarios

- (1) I have a friend who works from home and likes to host his friends at our place during the day. I work full-time and get home around 5:30 PM, but his friends usually stay until 7 PM. I find it hard to relax with people around when I get home. I asked my friend if we could stop hosting or if he could take them out when I arrive, but he said it wouldn’t be fair to his friends. They come over once or twice a week. Am I wrong for wanting some quiet time after work?
- (2) I was invited to a group dinner hosted by a vegan friend, who suggested bringing plant-based dishes so everyone could try everything. I brought both vegan and non-vegan dishes, clearly labeled. My friend seemed upset and later texted that it was disrespectful to bring animal products into their home. We’ve had non-vegan food there before, so I didn’t expect it to be an issue. Was I wrong?
- (3) I had dinner with a friend who made chicken with white rice, a salad with garlic, and some pickles and beetroot on the side. When asked how it was, I said it was fine and tasted as expected. My friend got upset, saying they added extra garlic and soy sauce, which I couldn’t taste. In their family, everyone praises the food, but in mine, we don’t. My friend left the dinner early, upset that I didn’t compliment the meal. Was I wrong for not reacting more enthusiastically?
- (4) My friend recently signed up for a half-marathon happening in December just to avoid going to an event that day. I